RB-102 Settlement consumer lag

Alert: SettlementConsumerLag

Fires when the settlement-consumer group is more than 250,000 messages behind for 10 minutes. Lag means payouts are late, not lost.

Find the cause

Open the consumer lag dashboard. Lag on every partition usually means the consumers are slow or crashing; lag on one partition usually means a poison message the consumer cannot parse.

Poison message

Find the offset in the consumer logs, copy the message to the dead letter topic, then skip it with kcat-skip --group settlement-consumer --partition <n> --offset <offset>. Record the offset in the incident channel so finance can settle it by hand.

Scaling

The topic has 24 partitions, so more than 24 consumers do nothing. Scale with kubectl scale deployment/settlement-consumer --replicas=24 -n payments.

Never

Never reset the group offsets to latest to clear lag. Every skipped message is a payout that is never settled.